Conversation track 15, 17, 18

Danielle and her partner Cyrus rent a tiny flat in Sydney.

Danielle: Don't laugh, but what if we moved to the country?

Cyrus: **Granted**, this place is tiny. But we'd be in the middle of nowhere.

Danielle: We both work from home, though. And the rent's half what we pay.

Cyrus: **Admittedly**, that's tempting. **Even so**, what would we do all weekend?

Danielle: Bushwalks, the beach, farmers' markets. You'd love it, I reckon.

Cyrus: I'd miss the food, though. Where would I get ramen at midnight?

Danielle: Fair point. **That said**, when did you last eat ramen at midnight?

Cyrus: Okay, you got me there. **Still**, I'm a city guy at heart.

Danielle: Then let's do a trial run. Just a month.

Cyrus: Fine. But the minute I see a snake, I'm out.

Study Notes

But we'd be in the middle of nowhere.
Nhưng mình sẽ ở chỗ khỉ ho cò gáy.
"in the middle of nowhere" = nơi hẻo lánh, xa mọi thứ. Người Anh, Úc còn nói "miles from anywhere".
Cách nói tương đương: But we'd be out in the sticks.

But the minute I see a snake, I'm out.
Nhưng hễ thấy rắn là anh chuồn ngay.
"the minute + mệnh đề" = ngay khi (thân mật hơn "as soon as"); "I'm out" = tôi rút, không chơi nữa.
Cách nói tương đương: As soon as I see a snake, I'm gone.

Speak Like a Native track 16

1. Admittedly, that's tempting.
change: "Admittedly" (t → d nhẹ)
strong: "Admittedly", "tempting"

Giọng Mỹ đọc "ơd-mí-đơd-li". Ngắt nhẹ sau "Admittedly", rồi xuống và hơi lên giọng ở "tempting": còn ý "nhưng" phía sau.

2. That said, when did you last eat ramen at midnight?
change: "did‿you" (d + y → "j")
linking: "last‿eat"
strong: "last", "midnight"

Giọng Úc thường đọc "last" với âm a dài /lɐːst/ như giọng Anh, khác giọng Mỹ /læst/. Nhấn "last" để trêu: lâu lắm rồi còn gì.

3. Fine. But the minute I see a snake, I'm out.
linking: "see‿a"
weak: "the", "a"
strong: "Fine", "snake", "out"

"Fine." xuống giọng, kéo dài: đồng ý miễn cưỡng. "see a" nối bằng âm "y": "si-yơ". Nhấn "snake", "out", giọng nửa đùa nửa thật.

- Giọng Mỹ: t giữa hai nguyên âm thành "d" nhẹ (Admittedly); t sau n hay bị nuốt khi nói nhanh (Granted → "gren-nịd").
- Giọng Úc và Anh đọc a dài trong last, after, can't; giọng Mỹ đọc âm /æ/ bẹt hơn.
- Sau Granted, Admittedly, That said: ngắt nhẹ để báo hiệu ý ngược lại sắp đến.
- Khi trêu hay phản bác, dồn trọng âm vào từ chốt: last, midnight, snake.

Grammar Focus

Granted, … / Admittedly, …: nhượng bộ trước khi phản bác

Granted: công nhận ý của người kia; Admittedly: thừa nhận một điều bất lợi cho chính mình. Sau đó thường là "But…".

Granted, it's pricey. But it'll last for years.
Admittedly, I've never actually been there.

That said, … / Even so, …: đưa ra ý ngược lại

Đứng đầu câu, sau khi đã nhượng bộ một ý, để nêu ý ngược lại; nghĩa gần "dù vậy". Still dùng tương tự.

The hotel was noisy. **That said**, the staff were lovely.
It might rain. **Even so**, we're going ahead.
I know it's late. **Still**, I'd like to finish this.

Role Play track 20

A: Don't laugh, but what if we moved to the country?

B: Granted, _____. But we'd be in the middle of nowhere.

A: We both work from home, though. And the rent's half what we pay.

B: _____, that's tempting. Even so, what would we do all weekend?

A: Bushwalks, the beach, farmers' markets. You'd love it, I reckon.

B: I'd miss the food, though. Where would I get ramen at midnight?

A: Fair point. That said, when did you last eat ramen at midnight?

B: Okay, you got me there. Still, I'm _____ at heart.

A: Then let's do a trial run. Just a month.

B: Fine. But the minute I see a snake, I'm out.

Substitution Drill track 21

1. Granted, this place is tiny.
   a. the rent's insane
   b. the traffic's awful
   c. we need more space

2. Admittedly, that's tempting.
   a. To be fair
   b. I'll admit
   c. Granted

3. Still, I'm a city guy at heart.
   a. a city slicker
   b. a New Yorker
   c. a night owl